



Making man pages useful

If you are looking for some help on a particular subject or command, man pages are a good place to start. You normally access a man page with the command `man <command>`. But you can also search the man pages' descriptions for a particular keyword. As an example, to search for man pages that discuss logins, use the following command:

```
#man -k login
```

When you access a man page, you can also use the forward slash key to search for a particular word within the man page itself. Simply press '/' on your keyboard and then type in the search term.

—Pallavi Rawat, pallavifirst@rediffmail.com

Mounting a Windows partition on Linux

When using Linux as the dual boot option with Windows 8/8.1/10, users often get an error message while mounting their NTFS partitions, such as: 'The NTFS partition is in an unsafe state. Please resume and shutdown Windows fully', along with other technical details of the error.

This happens due to the FastBoot feature of Windows 8/8.1/10, which keeps NTFS partitions in hibernated mode when Windows is shut down.

Once the hibernate flag is set to 'On' for the partition, Linux cannot mount that partition and considers it is being used in Windows.

This can be avoided by turning the FastBoot feature off. This may not cause any trouble, apart from users noticing an increased shutdown time for the Windows operating system. But they won't mind this difference if they're not frequent Windows users.

In Windows 8/8.1/10:

1. Open the control panel and from the small icons, view and click on *Power Options*.
2. Click on *Choose what the power buttons do*.
3. Click on *Change settings that are currently unavailable*.
4. Uncheck *Turn on fast startup* (recommended).

Completely restart Windows, log in to Linux and try to mount the NTFS partitions.

—Vinayak Kulkarni, kulkarnivd1989@gmail.com

How to manage files in the Linux terminal, using commands

To use the Linux terminal like a pro, you'll need to know the basics of managing files and navigating directories. True to the UNIX philosophy, each command does one thing and does it well. Midnight Commander, a full-featured file manager for the Linux terminal, acts as a powerful front-end to all these commands.

Most regular users know often-used commands like how to create, modify or delete. But the most important command to know about is how to view the full file manager.

mc - A Full File Manager

Midnight Commander is one of many full-featured file managers that you can use from the Linux terminal. It isn't installed by default on most distributions; so here's the command you'll need to install it on Ubuntu:

```
sudo apt-get install mc
```

After installation, just run the MC command. Use the arrow keys to select files and the tab key to switch between panes. Press *Alt-1* to see the *Help* screen or *Alt-2* for the menu.

You can also use the mouse in Midnight Commander if your terminal environment has mouse support.

—Gangappan Venkatesan, vgangacse@gmail.com

Removing all spaces or unwanted characters from the file name

Often, there are multiple spaces or unwanted characters in the file name, and it becomes annoying to access these files from the terminal. We can remove spaces from file names manually, but it becomes a tedious task when there are a large number of files involved. Fortunately,